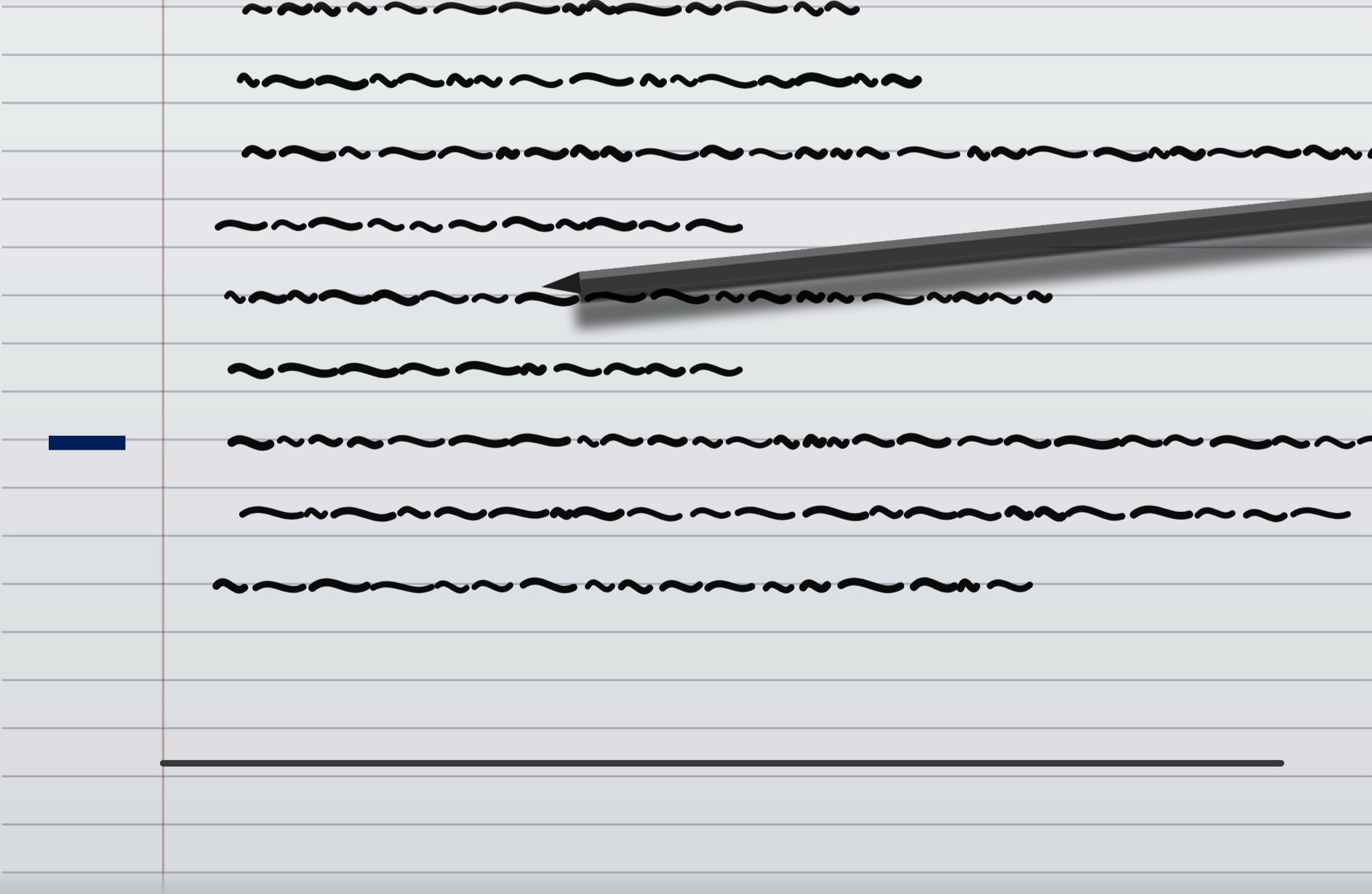


It was built to not tell you.

A federal grant is paying for a tutor that answers a student with a hint.



The problem, in the government's words.

The award that paid for the tutor says why it exists.

AWARD 2539663

STANDARD GRANT

IUSE

Context-Aware Conversational Tutors for Longitudinal Learning in Engineering Education

Generative Artificial Intelligence tools have created new challenges.

"students frequently use them to obtain answers rather than develop the reasoning and problem-solving skills that define engineering competence"

four undergraduate Industrial Engineering courses at the University of Texas at Arlington, spanning freshman through senior years

The courses do not change.

The instructor still teaches. The machine lives in the homework, across four undergraduate courses.

It started with her own children.

Shuchi Deb is an associate professor at the University of Texas at Arlington. She watched her own children and her students use AI without learning.

"They were just using AI to finish the assignment,"

SHUCHI DEB, IN THE UNIVERSITY'S RELEASE c5 c11

The university's own words for what it built.

teaches, not tells

FROM THE HEADLINE OF THE UNIVERSITY'S OWN RELEASE
SEPTEMBER 10TH, 2026 c1

The same machine is in a second room.

Testing with the Fort Worth Police Department has already begun.

Two agencies pay for this.

The release names the National Science Foundation up top.
The Department of Justice is a footnote.

Deb has already begun testing the system with the Fort Worth Police Department*, helping to develop training using real-life scenarios with prompts based on the principles of de-escalation.

The AI can tell when an officer is being kind and listening, when the officer picks up on something the person wants to talk about and follows that conversation, and when the officer doesn't connect with the person.

Then, the AI steers the interaction accordingly, giving officers perspective and practice in an environment where they can learn the skills they need for those high-pressure interactions.

*This work is sponsored by the Fort Worth Police Department and funded by the U.S. Department of Justice under Grant No.

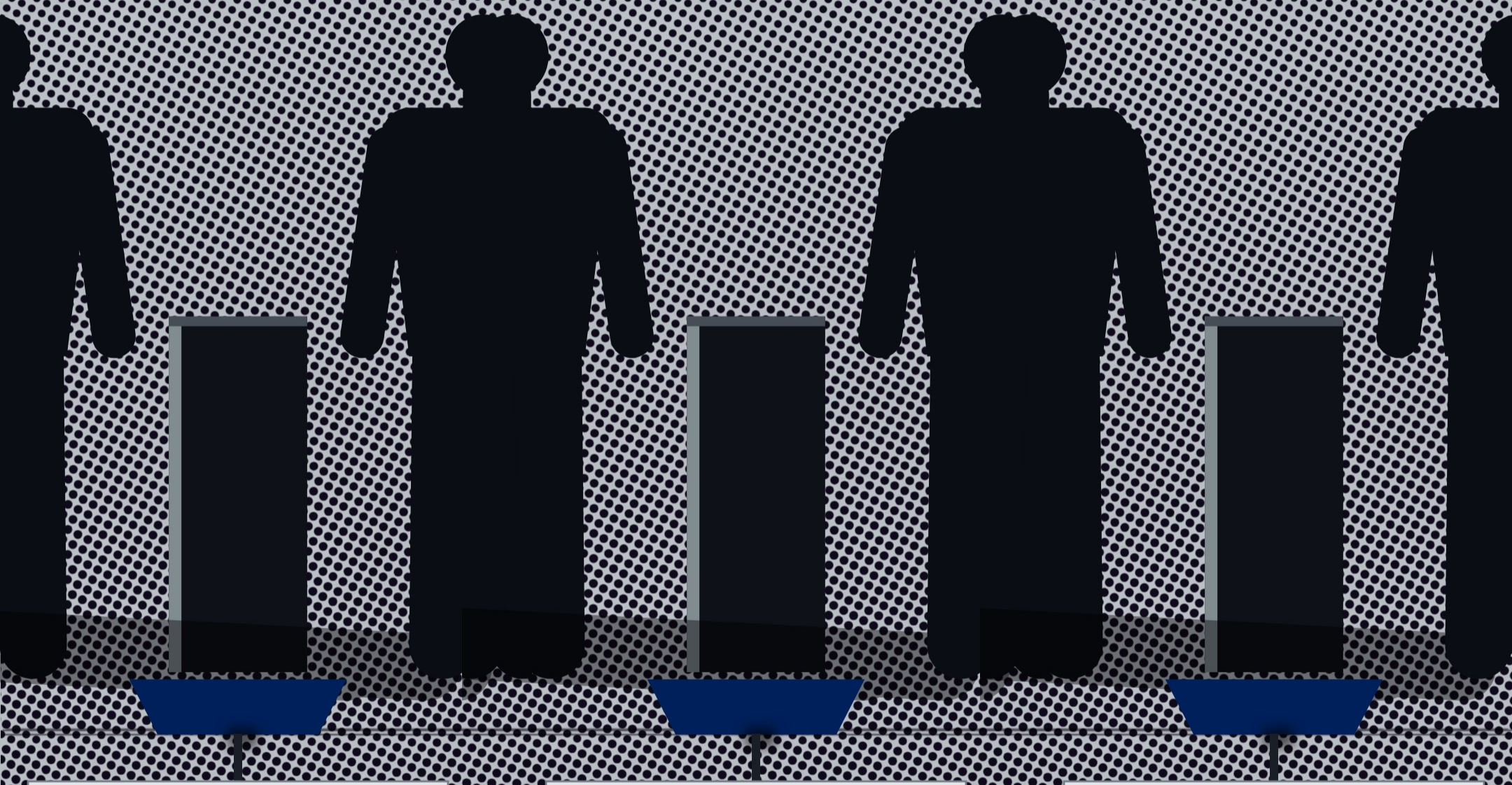
15PBJA-23-GG-06172-NTCP

THE FEDERAL RECORD FOR THAT NUMBER, NOT REACHED THIS RUN a4

THE FEDERAL RECORD FOR THE TUTOR, NO CARRIER
"funds0bligated":["FY 2026 = \$749,999.00"]
award 2539663 National Science Foundation

It reads three things.

Kind and listening. Following what the person wants to talk about. Not connecting.



KIND AND LISTENING

FOLLOWS THAT CONVERSATION

DOESN'T CONNECT WITH THE PERSON

Nothing has been graded yet.

The award starts October 1st, 2026 and runs to September 30th, 2029. Neither the university nor the federal record publishes a result.

